

BEFORE THE INTERVIEW

- **Reflect** on what the employer is looking for based on job posting and the qualities you possess that fit those requirements
- **Research** company (products, services, mission, goals, values and projects), the industry and competition
- **Prepare and practice** answers to anticipated interview questions
- **Practice your 30-second Elevator Pitch** – include relevant education, experience, strengths and reinforce your suitability for the job. This answers: “tell me about yourself?”
- Write at least 4 **success stories** to answer behavioural questions (*behavioural questions tipsheet*)
- List 4-5 **questions to ask** about the job, the company or industry (*questions to ask tipsheet*)
- **Research salary** and determine your worth (*questions to ask tipsheet*)
- Get permission from your **references** and get your reference list ready (*reference list tipsheet*)
- **Dress for success!** Research and ensure you dress professionally and suitable for the organization



COMMON INTERVIEW QUESTIONS

- *Tell me about yourself.*
- *Why did you leave or why are you leaving your last/current position?*
- *What do you know about this company?*
- *Why do you want to work for this company?*
- *What are your goals?*
- *What are your strengths and weaknesses?*
- *How would your last/current boss and colleagues describe you?*
- *Why should we hire you?*
- *What are your salary expectations? (questions to ask tipsheet)*
- *Do you have any questions for us? (questions to ask tipsheet)*

BEHAVIOURAL QUESTIONS

Use SAR Formula

S- Situation – Describe the situation

A- Action – What action did you take?

R- Result – What was the result (Remember it should be a POSITIVE)

Most behavioural questions centre on areas like **teamwork, customer service, decision making, initiative, adaptability and time management.**

Example Behavioural Questions (see *behavioural tipsheet*)

- Tell me about a time you worked on a difficult team.
- Tell me about a time when you had to deal with a difficult customer or coworker and how you dealt with it.
- Tell us about a time when you had to go above and beyond the call of duty in order to get a job done.
- Tell me about an accomplishment you are truly proud of.

WHAT TO BRING WITH YOU

- Several copies of your résumé on quality paper
- List of your 3 references
- Questions to ask interviewers
- Bottle of water
- Pens and a pad of paper on which to take notes
- Directions to interview site and contact info of the company
- Professional portfolio (if applicable)

ON ARRIVAL

- **Turn off** you cell phone
- **Arrive early** (10 to 15 minutes)
- Treat everyone you meet with **respect**
- **Greet interviewer** with a firm handshake
- **Smile and make eye contact**

DURING INTERVIEW

- **Focus** on the points you have prepared without sounding rehearsed or stiff
- **Sit up straight, smile, maintain eye contact**; sit still and avoid fidgeting and slouching
- **Listen** and give thoughtful and to-the-point answers. Ask for clarification if you are unsure. It is ok to pause and gather your thoughts before answering
- **Avoid making negative comments** about previous/current employers, professors or co-workers
- **Be enthusiastic**, confident and energetic, but not aggressive or pushy
- **Thank the interviewer** for their time at the close of the interview and establish a follow-up plan, ask for the interviewer's business card, offer a firm handshake, smile and make eye contact.



AFTER INTERVIEW

- **Make notes** so you don't forget critical details.
- **Send thank you note or email** within 24 hours. Reiterate your interest. (see thank you letter tipsheet)
- **Follow up.** If the employer said they would decide in a week, call them after the week is up to follow up
- Ask for feedback on your interview if you receive communication that you were not successful

OPTIMAL RÉSUMÉ - build cover letter, résumé or practice interview skills: georgebrown.optimalresume.com

St. James, 200 King Street (Room 155B), 416-415-5000 ext. 3818 sjcareercentre@georgebrown.ca
Casa Loma, 160 Kendal Avenue (Room C317), 416-415-5000 ext. 4100 clcareercentre@georgebrown.ca
Waterfront, 51 Dockside Drive (Room 017), 416-415-5000 ext. 5300 wfcareercentre@georgebrown.ca

GBCAREERS - view job postings and events: gbcareers.georgebrown.ca

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